

LOGISTICS & SUPPLY CHAIN

The last mile is the hard mile

Things cross an ocean on time and then get stuck in the last few miles to a store or a doorstep. Giant carriers have software for this. The florist, the food bank, and the two-van delivery company have a whiteboard and a group chat.

How might we help one small operator plan like a big one?

START HERE

When did a late or missing delivery cost you or your family something? Who was making the plan that day? What did they not know in time?

WHERE AI CAN WORK

- Putting stops in a sensible order and explaining why
- Guessing next week's demand from last month's numbers
- Turning tracking jargon into one clear sentence and a next step

YOU COULD BUILD

- A delivery planner: paste today's stops, get a plan and the customer texts
- An order suggester for a small shop or food pantry
- A "where is it stuck?" tracker mockup

THINK ABOUT (THIS IS SCORED)

Faster routes can mean more pressure on drivers; where are the breaks? If the AI is wrong, a truck goes to the wrong place, so how does someone check it? Location data is sensitive.

YOUR DAY

- 9:45** Meet your squad. Read this page.
- 10:00** Pick one real person with this problem.
- 10:30** Problem sentence read to your coach.
- 10:30** Build version one.
- 11:45** Lunch
- 12:30** Finish. Make your risks slide.
- 1:10** Stop building. Practice the pitch.
- 1:30** Pitch to your track: 3 minutes.
- 2:15** Finals and awards, Dyer Hall

HOW YOU ARE SCORED

- 25 Problem clarity:** real, specific, belongs to a person
- 25 Use of AI:** AI does real work, not decoration
- 20 Feasibility:** someone could use it and it would matter
- 15 Responsible design:** bias, privacy, who could be harmed
- 15 The pitch:** clear, honest, everyone speaks

Squad name: _____ Who we are building for: _____

YOUR PROBLEM SENTENCE — write it before you build anything

_____ (a real person) struggles with _____
 because _____. We will build _____
 so they can _____.

YOUR 3-MINUTE PITCH

Meet the person (30 sec). Their problem today (30). What you built and what the AI does, shown live if you can (75). What could go wrong and your safeguard (30). What comes next (15).

RULES

Coaches and mentors help, but never build or present for you. Never type real private information about anyone into an AI tool. Check what the AI tells you; it can be confidently wrong. A working app, a set-up AI assistant, a clickable mockup, or a clear plan with one worked example can all win.

NOTES & SKETCHES

Toolkit links and all six challenges
longbeachaihackathon.org/briefs

